some reason for such a perception about the concept of income. Basically, when the idea of 'human development' came into being by early 1990s, the concept of the 'human development index' ultimately was heavily dependent on the level of 'income' of individual in a country. Education and life expectancy can only be enhanced once the required amount of 'investment' (expenditure on them) could be mobilised. Thus, somehow, income came to be established as the 'focal point' of 'development/human dvelopment'.

As income of a single person can be measured, it can be measured for a nation and the whole world, although the method of calculating may be a little bit complex in the latter's case. In due course of time, *four ideas/ways* to calculate the income of a nation[8] developed, which are the subject matter of the 'national income accounting'- an area to which the disciplines Commerce and Statistics are closer. These four ways to look upon 'income' of an economy, although different from each other in some way, are the concepts of GDP, NDP, GNP and NNP. All are a form of the national income, but are different from one another. They all say a different story about the income of a nation in their own specific way. Here, we discuss them in a very objective way.

GDP

Gross Domestic Product (GDP) is the value of the all *final* goods and services produced within the boundary of a nation during one year. For India, this calendar year is from 1st April to 31st March.

It will be better to understand the terms used in the concept, *'gross'* means same thing to Economics and Commerce as 'total' means to Mathematics; *'domestic'* means all the economic activities done inside the boundary of the nation/country and by its own capital; *'product'* is word to define 'goods and services' together; and *'final'* means the stage of a product after which there is no known chance of value addition in it.].

The ***different uses*** of the concept GDP are as given below:

(i) Per annum percentage change in it is the 'growth rate' of an economy. For example, if a country has a GDP of Rs. 107 which is 7 rupees higher than the last year, it has a growth rate of 7 per cent.